

● EASY

● ALGEBRA

● ANSWER KEY

Linear equations in two variables

04

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Q1**-32**

The correct answer is -32. It's given that the y-intercept of the graph of $y = -6x - 32$ is 0, y. Substituting 0 for x in this equation yields $y = -60 - 32$, or $y = -32$. Therefore, the value of y that corresponds to the y-intercept of the graph of $y = -6x - 32$ in the xy-plane is -32.

Q2**B****B. 3**

Choice B is correct. It's given that the equation $y = 0.1x$ models the relationship between the number of different pieces of music a certain pianist practices, y, and the number of minutes in a practice session, x. Since it's given that the session lasted 30 minutes, the number of pieces the pianist practiced can be found by substituting 30 for x in the given equation, which yields $y = 0.1(30)$, or $y = 3$.

Choices A and C are incorrect and may result from misinterpreting the values in the equation. Choice D is incorrect. This is the given value of x, not the value of y.

Q3

C

C. $1.53a + 1.44b = 35(1.49)$

Choice C is correct. It's given that in 2010, a swim club had a total of 35 swimmers, each classified as either advanced or intermediate, and that a represents the number of advanced swimmers in 2010 and b represents the number of intermediate swimmers in 2010. It's also given that from 2010 to 2020, the number of advanced swimmers in the club increased by approximately 53% and the number of intermediate swimmers in the club increased by approximately 44%. Thus, in 2020, the approximate number of advanced swimmers in the club can be represented as $1.53a$ and the approximate number of intermediate swimmers in the club can be represented as $1.44b$. It's given that the total number of swimmers in the club increased by approximately 49% from 2010 to 2020. Since the club had 35 swimmers in 2010, it follows that the total number of swimmers in 2020 can be represented as $35(1.49)$. Since the sum of the number of advanced swimmers in 2020 and the number of intermediate swimmers in 2020 equals the total number of swimmers in 2020, the equation $1.53a + 1.44b = 35(1.49)$ best represents this situation.

Choice A is incorrect. This equation represents a situation where the number of intermediate swimmers in the club in 2020 increased by approximately 49%, not 44%, and the total number of swimmers in the club in 2020 increased by approximately 44%, not 49%.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from conceptual errors.

Choice D is incorrect. This equation represents a situation where the number of advanced swimmers in the club in 2020 increased by approximately 44%, not 53%, and the number of intermediate swimmers in the club in 2020 increased by approximately 53%, not 44%.

Q4

B

B. 4

Choice B is correct. It's given that a represents the number of small boxes and b represents the number of large boxes the customer had shipped. If the customer had 3 small boxes shipped, then $a = 3$. Substituting 3 for a in the equation $3a + 4b = 25$ yields $3(3) + 4b = 25$ or $9 + 4b = 25$. Subtracting 9 from both sides of the equation yields $4b = 16$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 4 yields $b = 4$. Therefore, the customer had 4 large boxes shipped.

Choices A, C, and D are incorrect. If the number of large boxes shipped is 3, then $b = 3$. Substituting 3 for b in the given equation yields $3a + 4(3) = 25$ or $3a + 12 = 25$. Subtracting 12 from both sides of the equation and then dividing by 3 yields $a = \frac{13}{3}$. However, it's given that the number of small boxes shipped, a , is 3, not $\frac{13}{3}$, so b cannot equal 3. Similarly, if $b = 5$ or $b = 6$, then $a = \frac{5}{3}$ or $a = \frac{1}{3}$, respectively, which is also not true.

Q5**A**

A. $y = -\frac{1}{4}x - 1$

Choice A is correct. The slope of the line can be found by choosing any two points on the line, such as $(4, -2)$ and $(0, -1)$. Subtracting the y-values results in $-2 - (-1) = -1$, the change in y. Subtracting the x-values results in $4 - 0 = 4$, the change in x. Dividing the change in y by the change in x yields $-1 \div 4 = -\frac{1}{4}$, the slope. The line intersects the y-axis at $(0, -1)$, so -1 is the y-coordinate of the y-intercept. This information can be expressed in slope-intercept form as the equation $y = -\frac{1}{4}x - 1$.

Choice B is incorrect and may result from incorrectly calculating the slope and then misidentifying the slope as the y-intercept. Choice C is incorrect and may result from misidentifying the slope as the y-intercept. Choice D is incorrect and may result from incorrectly calculating the slope.

Q6**A**

A. $y = 2x + 3$

Choice A is correct. Each of the choices is a linear equation in the form $y = mx + b$, where m and b are constants. In this equation, m represents the change in y for each increase in x by 1. From the table, it can be determined that the value of y increases by 2 for each increase in x by 1. In other words, for the pairs of x and y in the given table, $m = 2$. The value of b can be found by substituting the values of x and y from any row of the table and substituting the value of m into the equation $y = mx + b$ and then solving for b . For example, using $x = 1$, $y = 5$, and $m = 2$ yields $5 = 2(1) + b$. Solving for b yields $b = 3$. Therefore, the equation $y = 2x + 3$ could represent the relationship between x and y in the given table.

Alternatively, if an equation represents the relationship between x and y , then when each pair of x and y from the table is substituted into the equation, the result will be a true statement. Of the equations given, the equation $y = 2x + 3$ in choice A is the only equation that results in a true statement when each of the pairs of x and y are substituted into the equation.

Choices B, C, and D are incorrect because when at least one pair of x and y from the table is substituted into the equations given in these choices, the result is a false statement. For example, when the pair $x = 4$ and $y = 11$ is substituted into the equation in choice B, the result is $11 = 3(4) - 2$, or $11 = 10$, which is false.

Q7**B**

B. $1.5x + 1.9y = 46.1$

Choice B is correct. It's given that the employee takes 1.5 minutes to prepare a sandwich. Multiplying 1.5 by the number of sandwiches, x , yields $1.5x$, the amount of time the employee spends preparing x sandwiches. It's also given that the employee takes 1.9 minutes to prepare a salad. Multiplying 1.9 by the number of salads, y , yields $1.9y$, the amount of time the employee spends preparing y salads. It follows that the total amount of time, in minutes, the employee spends preparing x sandwiches and y salads is $1.5x + 1.9y$. It's given that the employee spends a total of 46.1 minutes preparing x sandwiches and y salads. Thus, the equation $1.5x + 1.9y = 46.1$ represents this situation.

Choice A is incorrect. This equation represents a situation where it takes the employee 1.9 minutes, rather than 1.5 minutes, to prepare a sandwich and 1.5 minutes, rather than 1.9 minutes, to prepare a salad.

Choice C is incorrect. This equation represents a situation where it takes the employee 1 minute, rather than 1.5 minutes, to prepare a sandwich and 1 minute, rather than 1.9 minutes, to prepare a salad.

Choice D is incorrect. This equation represents a situation where it takes the employee 30.7 minutes, rather than 1.5 minutes, to prepare a sandwich and 24.3 minutes, rather than 1.9 minutes, to prepare a salad.

Q8**C****C.** 100

Choice C is correct. Let d represent the mass, in grams, of vitamin D in the mixture, and let c represent the mass, in grams, of calcium in the mixture. It's given that the mixture consists of only vitamin D and calcium and that the total mass of the mixture is 150 grams. Therefore, the equation $d + c = 150$ represents this situation. It's also given that the mass of vitamin D in the mixture is 50 grams. Substituting 50 for d in the equation $d + c = 150$ yields $50 + c = 150$. Subtracting 50 from both sides of this equation yields $c = 100$. Therefore, the mass of calcium in the mixture is 100 grams.

Choice A is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Choice B is incorrect. This is the total mass, in grams, of the mixture, not the mass, in grams, of calcium in the mixture.

Choice D is incorrect. This is the mass, in grams, of vitamin D in the mixture, not the mass, in grams, of calcium in the mixture.

Q9**4**

The correct answer is 4. It's given that line k is parallel to line j . It follows that the slope of line k is equal to the slope of line j . Given two points on a line in the xy -plane, x_1, y_1 and x_2, y_2 , the slope of the line can be calculated as $\frac{y_2 - y_1}{x_2 - x_1}$. In the xy -plane shown, the points 0, 5 and 1, 9 are on line j . It follows that the slope of line j is $\frac{9 - 5}{1 - 0}$, or 4. Since the slope of line j is equal to the slope of line k , the slope of line k is also 4.

Q10

B

B. The price, in dollars, of one salad

Choice B is correct. It's given that $2.50x + 7.00y$ is equal to the total amount of money, in dollars, a food truck charges for x drinks and y salads. Since each salad has the same price, it follows that the total charge for y salads is $7.00y$ dollars. When $y = 1$, the value of the expression $7.00y$ is 7.00×1 , or 7.00. Therefore, the price for one salad is 7.00 dollars.

Choice A is incorrect. Since each drink has the same price, it follows that the total charge for x drinks is $2.50x$ dollars. Therefore, the price, in dollars, for one drink is 2.50, not 7.00. Choices C and D are incorrect. In the given equation, F represents the total charge, in dollars, when x drinks and y salads are bought at the food truck. No information is provided about the number of drinks or the number of salads that are bought during the day. Therefore, 7.00 doesn't represent either of these quantities.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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